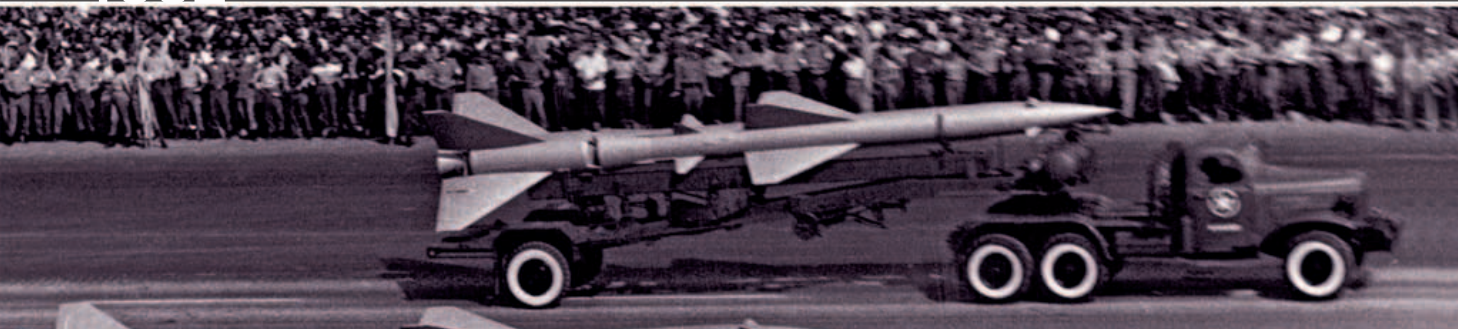




Soviet missiles are displayed at a parade in Havana. The US came close to confrontation with the Soviet Union over the establishment of Soviet nuclear installations on Cuba.

“WE’RE EYEBALL TO EYEBALL AND THE OTHER FELLOW JUST BLINKED.”

Dean Rusk, US Secretary of State, on the Cuban crisis in 1962

PRESIDENT CHARLES DE GAULLE OF FRANCE reached an agreement with Algerian nationalists in March to proceed with Algerian independence. **The Organization Armée Secrète** (OAS), a secret organization of army officers who wanted Algeria to remain a French colony, launched a wave of bomb attacks across Paris and

made repeated attempts on De Gaulle’s life. **Algeria** gained **independence** from France on July 3, after a referendum held in January backed the move. It brought an end to eight years of civil unrest and guerrilla warfare. French officials estimated it had cost 350,000 lives; Algerian sources put the figure at 1.5 million.

Telstar, the world’s **first communication satellite**, was launched on July 10 from Cape Canaveral. In the early hours of July 11, live transatlantic television pictures were sent from Maine in the US to Goonhilly in Cornwall, England.

The US was back in the news when screen idol **Marilyn Monroe**, was found dead in her Los

Marilyn Monroe

At the time of her death Marilyn Monroe was a huge star who had appeared in 29 movies. The Misfits was her last film.

Angeles apartment on August 5. She was 36 years old. There was much speculation about the cause of her death; the coroner reported a “probable suicide,” but many believed she had accidentally overdosed on sleeping tablets.

Meanwhile, **Nelson Mandela**—leader of Umkhonto we Sizwe, the armed wing of the African National Congress (ANC)—was arrested on August 5 after 17 months on the run. Convicted of sabotage, he was **jailed for five years** on November 7.

Jamaica became **independent** within the British Commonwealth on August 6, with **Alexander Bustamante** (1884–1977) of the Jamaica Labor Party as prime minister. He would oversee several years of growth under his moderately conservative government.

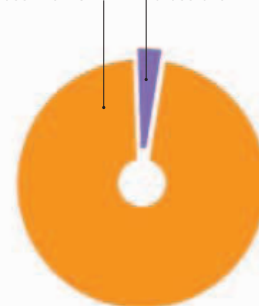
The people of Berlin were not celebrating any such freedom after the construction of the **Berlin Wall** (see 1961). **Peter Fechter**, an 18-year-old German bricklayer, became one of the first victims of the Berlin Wall’s border guards after he was shot trying to cross from East to West Berlin.

In Britain, Liverpool-based rock band **The Beatles** finally signed with the record company EMI on June 4. They had previously auditioned for several record companies, but despite the enthusiasm of their manager, Brian Epstein, they had been turned down. “**Love Me Do**”, their first single, was released on October 5, and spent 18 weeks in the charts.

In the US, concerns were growing over the alliance of **Cuba** and the **USSR**. The installation of Soviet missiles on Cuba had reduced the warning time of a nuclear attack on the US from 15 minutes to two. In October, **President Kennedy** ordered a blockade of the island to prevent the arrival of more missiles, and delivered an ultimatum to the Russian leader, **Nikita Khrushchev**, to remove existing missiles. The world was on the brink of nuclear war, but Khrushchev finally backed down. This incident became known as the **Cuban Missile Crisis**.

India and **China** were fighting their own battle in a short but bloody **border war** over their claims to the Aksai Chin Plateau, on India’s northeast frontier. Chinese troops advanced into India on October 20, but declared a ceasefire on November 21.

5,000 attempted to cross the wall
around 150 were killed trying to cross over



Crossing the Berlin Wall

Many people made desperate attempts to escape over the Berlin Wall from East to West Germany between 1961 and 1989.



Martin Luther King salutes the crowd from the steps of the Lincoln Memorial.

THE 1960S SAW THE REKINDLING

of the women’s liberation movement. **Betty Friedan** (1921–2006) identified some of the frustrations felt by American housewives in her book *The Feminine Mystique*, which was published in February, and helped start a “**second wave**” of **feminism** in the US.

In another display of unity, the heads of states of 32 African countries signed a charter on May 25, setting up the **Organization of African Unity** (OAU). Their aims were to promote African solidarity, end colonialism, and to coordinate the economic, political, health, scientific, defence, and cultural policies of the members. The conference, hosted by **Haile Selassie** of Ethiopia, also planned to support African freedom fighters by supplying arms, training, and military bases.

Kenya, an early member of the OAU, became the 34th African nation to achieve independence. **Jomo Kenyatta** (1894–1978) was elected leader of the Kenya African National Union after nine years in prison, and won the national election in May. Kenyatta became prime minister and led Kenya from self-government to **full independence** on December 12.

In Europe, US **president John F. Kennedy** made a morale-boosting **speech in Berlin** on June 26. In it he offered solidarity to the citizens of West Germany, who were alarmed at the construction of the Berlin Wall. Thousands gathered in

January 8
French vote
for Algerian
independence

May 10 President
Kennedy sends US
marines into Laos

May 31 Adolf Eichmann
hanged for Nazi war crimes

July 3 Algeria gains
independence from France

August 5 US film star,
Marilyn Monroe, found
dead (b. 1926)

August 6 Jamaica gains
independence

August 17 Peter
Fechter gunned down
on Berlin Wall

October 14–28 Cuban
Missile Crisis brings
world to brink of nuclear war

October 10–November 21
Indo-China war

November 7 Nelson
Mandela jailed for five
years in South Africa

January 13
Military coup in Togo

February 19
Publication of Betty
Friedman’s *The
Feminine Mystique*

January 29 Death
of US poet Robert
Frost (b. 1874)

April 23 Death of Israeli
president Yitzhak
Ben-Zvi (b. 1884)